then that she couldn’t throw his drawing and his words into the river. It was a piece of him she would keep forever. She put the paper back in her pocket.

On 7 May, Reinhardt told her he was ready. They walked to the edge of the town, taking the forest path up a steep hill. It was one she’d never used before, a switchback that smoothed out the sharp bends.

“How long is it to reach the farm?” she asked, breathless, halfway up.

“One kilometer.” He smiled. “No Soviet soldier will run up here by mistake.”

“What about the winters?” She couldn’t imagine walking this in thick snow.

“There are sleds and snowshoes at the farm. But we will have goats. I hope we can become self-sufficient.”

“We will live off goats?”

“Chickens, too. Nothing commercial. Just enough for us to get by. You will see.”

At the top, the view was magnificent—the entire Müglitz Valley, with its mountains and rivers, extended in all directions. Not far from the path stood a small wooden house with a sloping roof, set off to one side and nestled against a hill. Next to it a small barn. There was a porch outside the house.

“What do you think?” he asked.

“It’s fine.” She thought of André’s house. The olive tree in the courtyard, the windows that opened to the outside like doors. And it suddenly struck her what sort of life she’d given up.

Luckily, there were two bedrooms. Rose was grateful that he honored their agreement. That night, she went to bed, the window open, the sound of the wind whistling through the trees. She awoke to a full moon shining its bright light into the room. And she thought of drawing the white and gray light radiating from the moon.

She sat up. It suddenly struck her that she’d left her drawings and sketches at the barracks. She’d been so torn apart by sending André and Léa away that in the four days she’d waited for Reinhardt, she’d not taken them. She felt a stabbing at her chest at the possibility that someone would find them and throw them out. They were her only reminders of Léa and André and all the women she’d drawn at the sick bay. She couldn’t abandon them,